You can also import values into a settings.py file. The mechanism I use personally is a little convoluted, but I'm happy with it. I use settings.py for values common to all environments, and then import extra files based on the deployment environment. The module of the extra files is itself read out of a file. This level of indirection allows you to store all the files in your repo but configure for the deployment target by changing the contents of the indirection file.

I store all the environment files in a directory called *local_settings*, and the indirection file is named *import_redirect*. This file contains the name of the modules to import into the configuration. Code at the bottom of settings.py reads the module name from import_redirect and then dynamically imports that module.

Additionally, there is also a directory called *secrets*, containing the files with the same names as the local settings. These files contain configuration values that should not be stored in the code repo, like passwords and secret keys. The relationship between all these files is shown in figure B.2.

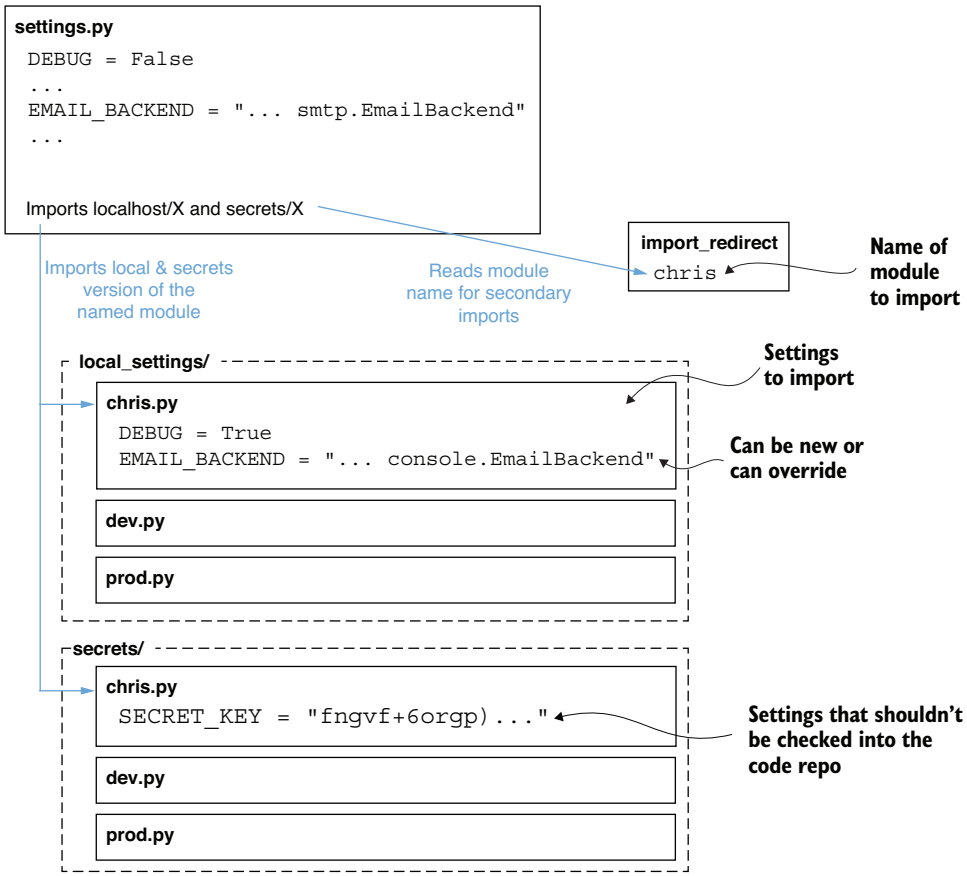


Figure B.2 Using separate subsettings files for environment-specific settings and secrets